STUDY AID · MATTHEW 28 · EPISODE 55 (#58 OF 58 IN THE PLAYLIST)

In the *Name*

Power, authority and presence

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 28 in the LSB | 30:17 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: The Most Overlooked Line in the Great Commission. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads all of Matthew 28. After the Sabbath, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary come to the grave. An earthquake, an angel like lightning, the stone rolled away, the guards like dead men. 'He is not here, for He has risen, just as He said.' Jesus meets the women, and they take hold of His feet and worship Him. The chief priests and elders pay the soldiers to say the disciples stole the body. In Galilee, on the mountain Jesus designated, the eleven worship, though some doubt, and Jesus gives the Great Commission.
- The other accounts are Mark 16, Luke 24 and John 20 (the earliest manuscripts of Mark lack 16:9-20). No Gospel describes the resurrection itself; it is told through witnesses: an angel, the soldiers, the women and the disciples. The leaders hear the testimony and refuse to believe, though at the cross they had said, 'we will believe in Him' (27:42).
- The women are the first to see Him. Because a woman's testimony was not usually accepted in court then, a made-up story would not have put them first, which points to the account's truthfulness. Which mountain is unknown (Tabor? Hermon?). 'Doubted' means wavered or hesitated. The Commission has one command, 'make disciples'; everything else serves it.
- Connections: the Sabbath rest (Exodus 16:29; Isaiah 58:13); the angel like Daniel's (Daniel 10:5-6, 12; 7:9) and Ezekiel's living creatures (Ezekiel 1:14); the third day (Hosea 6:2) and Psalm 16:10 as Peter and Paul read it

> *"In Jesus, the disciples possess the power, the authority, and the presence of God. Therefore, they must go and immerse others into this same power, authority, and presence.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Even in post-resurrection, Jesus is still the rabbi, right?*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

(Acts 2; 13:36-37); 'all authority' and Daniel 7:13-14; the name of God as presence (Numbers 6:27; Exodus 23:21), authority (Deuteronomy 18:19) and power (Psalm 20:1, 5, 7).

- The lesson: in Jesus, the disciples possess the power, the authority and the presence of God; therefore they must go and immerse others into this same power, authority and presence.

Find the main verb

In a long command, find the one main verb and ask how every other phrase serves it. In 28:19-20 it is 'make disciples.'

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB. This is Episode 55, the last of the Matthew study (playlist item 58).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 28 and turns to Mark 16, Luke 24, John 20, Exodus 16 and 23, Isaiah 58, Daniel 7 and 10, Ezekiel 1, Hosea 6, Psalms 16 and 20, Acts 13, Numbers 6, Deuteronomy 18 and Romans 6. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 28:1-20
Read in full.

Mark 16:1-8
Mark's account of the women.

Luke 24:1-10
Luke's account of the women.

John 20:1-18
John's account: Mary Magdalene.

Matthew 27:42
'We will believe in Him.'

Exodus 16:29
Remain every man in his place.

Isaiah 58:13
Call the sabbath a delight.

Daniel 10:5-12
A man whose face was like lightning.

Ezekiel 1:14
The appearance of lightning.

Daniel 7:9-14
Clothing white as snow; dominion given.

Hosea 6:2
On the third day.

Psalm 16:8–11
Not to see corruption.

Acts 13:34–37
Paul on Psalm 16.

Exodus 23:20–21
My name is in him.

Numbers 6:22–27
They shall invoke My name.

Deuteronomy 18:18–19
The prophet who speaks in My name.

Psalm 20:1–7
The name of the God of Jacob.

Romans 6:1–13
Baptized into His death.

Key verses in the LSB

"He is not here, for He has risen, just as He said. Come, see the place where He was lying."
Matthew 28:6 (LSB)

"Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit,"
Matthew 28:19 (LSB)

"and behold, I am with you always, even to the end of the age."
Matthew 28:20 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The empty tomb

The angel, the women, and 'He has risen.'

MATTHEW 28:1–4; DANIEL 10:6

Like lightning

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 28:2–3
"And behold, there was a great earthquake, for an angel of the Lord descended from heaven and came and rolled away the stone and sat upon it. And his appearance was like lightning, and his clothing as white as snow."

DANIEL · DANIEL 10:6
"His body also was like beryl, his face had the appearance of lightning, his eyes were like flaming torches, his arms and feet like the gleam of burnished bronze, and the sound of his words like the sound of a multitude."

FROM THE VIDEO Daniel's angel also says, 'Do not be afraid' (Daniel 10:12). Ezekiel's living creatures move 'with the appearance of lightning' (Ezekiel 1:14), and the Ancient of Days wears clothing 'like white snow' (Daniel 7:9): perhaps a sign of the closeness angels enjoy

with God. Daniel 10:12 Ezekiel 1:14 Daniel 7:9

FROM THE VIDEO The women waited until after the Sabbath (Exodus 16:29; Isaiah 58:13): grief and reverence at once. Exodus 16:29 Isaiah 58:13

◆ Factbook: Angel ◆ Factbook: Daniel (the prophet) ◆ Factbook: Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Sabbath



MATTHEW 28:5-10

He has risen, just as He said

MATTHEW 28:9-10 (LSB)

FIRST WITNESSES

“And behold, Jesus met them and said, “Greetings!” And they came up and took hold of His feet and worshiped Him. Then Jesus *said to them, “Do not be afraid; go and report to My brothers to leave for Galilee, and there they will see Me.””

FROM THE VIDEO No one describes the resurrection itself. The soldiers are the first potential witnesses, but they never see Him. The first to see Jesus alive are the women, then the disciples.

FROM THE VIDEO A woman's testimony was not usually accepted in court in the first century. Had the disciples invented the story, they would not have made women the first witnesses.

FROM THE VIDEO The video suggests Matthew tells verses 2-4 before verse 1 in time, comparing Mark 16:1, where the women come with spices to anoint Him. Mark 16:1

◆ Factbook: Resurrection ◆ Factbook: Galilee ◆ Factbook: Worship



An angel of the Lord came and rolled away the stone and sat upon it

James Tissot, The Angel Seated on the Stone of the Tomb, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain



Jesus met them and said, 'Greetings!'

James Tissot, Jesus Appears to the Holy Women, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> ***The Great Commission is not something to tread over too quickly. It's something upon which to meditate again and again and again and again.***
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Witnesses

The guards' story, the mountain, and the third day.

MATTHEW 28:11-15; 27:42

A large sum of money

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 28:12-13

“And when they had assembled with the elders and took counsel together, they gave a large sum of money to the soldiers, and said, “You are to say, ‘His disciples came by night and stole Him away while we were asleep.’”

THE LEADERS AT THE CROSS · MATTHEW 27:42

““He saved others; He cannot save Himself. He is the King of Israel; let Him now come down from the cross, and we will believe in Him.”

FROM THE VIDEO The leaders are witnesses too: they hear the guards' report and still refuse to believe. Matthew shows they never meant to believe.

◆ Factbook: Elder

MATTHEW 28:16-17

Some doubted

MATTHEW 28:16-17 (LSB)

WHICH MOUNTAIN?

“But the eleven disciples proceeded to Galilee, to the mountain which Jesus had designated. And when they saw Him, they worshiped Him; but some doubted.”

FROM THE VIDEO Which mountain? Tabor, another hill in Galilee, or Hermon just to the north? We are not told. A teacher the video cites notes that the trip back would retrace places of earlier lessons: even after the resurrection, Jesus is still the rabbi.

FROM THE VIDEO 'Doubted' means to waver or hesitate: perhaps they did not yet know how to react to seeing Him alive.

◆ Factbook: Mount Tabor ◆ Factbook: Mount Hermon ◆ Factbook: Disciples

HOSEA 6:2; PSALM 16:10; ACTS 13:36-37

On the third day

DAVID · PSALM 16:10

“For You will not forsake my soul to Sheol; / You will not give Your Holy One over to see corruption.”

PAUL · ACTS 13:36-37

“For David, after he had served the purpose of God in his own generation, fell asleep and was laid among his fathers and saw corruption; but He whom God raised did not see corruption.”

FROM THE VIDEO The resurrection of the Messiah had precedent: 'He will raise us up on the third day' (Hosea 6:2). Peter (Acts 2) and Paul (Acts 13) read Psalm 16:10 as fulfilled in Jesus, since David's body did see corruption. Hosea 6:2 Acts 2:27

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms ◆ Factbook: Hosea (the prophet) ◆ Factbook: Sheol ◆ Factbook: David ◆ Factbook: Paul

> *“Even in post-resurrection, Jesus is still the rabbi, right?*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

In the name

The Great Commission and the name of God.

MATTHEW 28:18-20; DANIEL 7:14

Three 'alls'

JESUS · MATTHEW 28:18-19

“And Jesus came up and spoke to them, saying, “All authority has been given to Me in heaven and on earth. Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and the Son and the Holy Spirit,”

DANIEL · DANIEL 7:14

“And to Him was given dominion, / Glory, and a kingdom, / That all the peoples, nations, and men of every tongue / Might serve Him.”

FROM THE VIDEO All authority, all the nations, all that I commanded. In the Greek the one command is 'make disciples'; going, baptizing and teaching serve it. That is a slow, intentional process, like Jesus' own with His disciples.

FROM THE VIDEO 'Therefore' ties verse 19 to verse 18: the mission rests on Jesus' authority. 'I am with you always' is fulfilled through the Spirit (John 14-17; Acts 2) until He returns. John 14:16-17 Acts 2:1-4

◆ Factbook: Son of Man ◆ Factbook: Holy Spirit ◆ Factbook: Trinity ◆ Factbook: Baptism

NUMBERS 6:24-27; EXODUS 23:21

The name is His presence

✨ NUMBERS 6:24-27 (LSB)

PRESENCE

“Yahweh bless you, and keep you; / Yahweh make His face shine on you, / And be gracious to you; / Yahweh lift up His face on you, / And give you peace.’ So they shall invoke My name on the sons of Israel, and I then will bless them.””

FROM THE VIDEO The name of God is not a phrase to close a prayer but His power, authority and presence. In the priestly blessing, God's name on Israel is His face shining on them: His presence.

FROM THE VIDEO Of the angel sent before Israel, God says, 'My name is in him' (Exodus 23:21). See also Exodus 33:18-19, 1 Kings 8:27-29 and Joel 2:32. Exodus 23:21 Exodus 33:18-19 1 Kings 8:27-29 Joel 2:32

◆ Factbook: Aaron ◆ Factbook: Moses

DEUTERONOMY 18:19; PSALM 20:7

Authority and power

MOSES · DEUTERONOMY 18:19

“And it will be that whoever will not listen to My words which he shall speak in My name, I Myself will require it of him.”

DAVID · PSALM 20:7

“Some boast in chariots and some in horses, / But we will boast in the name of Yahweh, our God.”

FROM THE VIDEO The prophet like Moses speaks 'in My name': with God's authority. David speaks of God's saving power as His name: 'May the name of the God of Jacob set you securely on high!' (Psalm 20:1). Psalm 20:1

FROM THE VIDEO So to baptize 'in the name' is to immerse people into the power, authority and presence of God, a whole way of living, not a magic phrase.

◆ Factbook: Jacob (son of Isaac)



Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations

Duccio di Buoninsegna, Appearance on the Mountain in Galilee, 1308-1311 (Maestà). Via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *"This is about spending a duration of time with people so they can be baptized into so much more than that.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in Matthew 28

What the video says, then a short background note.

Mary Magdalene and the other Mary

VIDEO Wait out the Sabbath, find the empty tomb, and are the first to see Jesus.

BACKGROUND Mark adds Salome and names the other Mary as the mother of James (Mark 16:1).

Matthew 28:1 Mark 16:1 ◆ Mary (Magdalene) ◆ Mary (mother of James and Joseph) ◆ Salome (witnessed the crucifixion)

The angel of the Lord

VIDEO Rolls away the stone and tells the women not to be afraid.

BACKGROUND Like the figures in Daniel's visions (Daniel 10:6).

Matthew 28:2-7 ◆ Angel

The guards

VIDEO First potential witnesses, who never see Him; then paid to lie.

BACKGROUND They answered to the chief priests and to Pilate (27:65-66).

Matthew 28:4 | Matthew 28:11-15

The eleven

VIDEO Worship on the mountain, though some doubt, and receive the Commission.

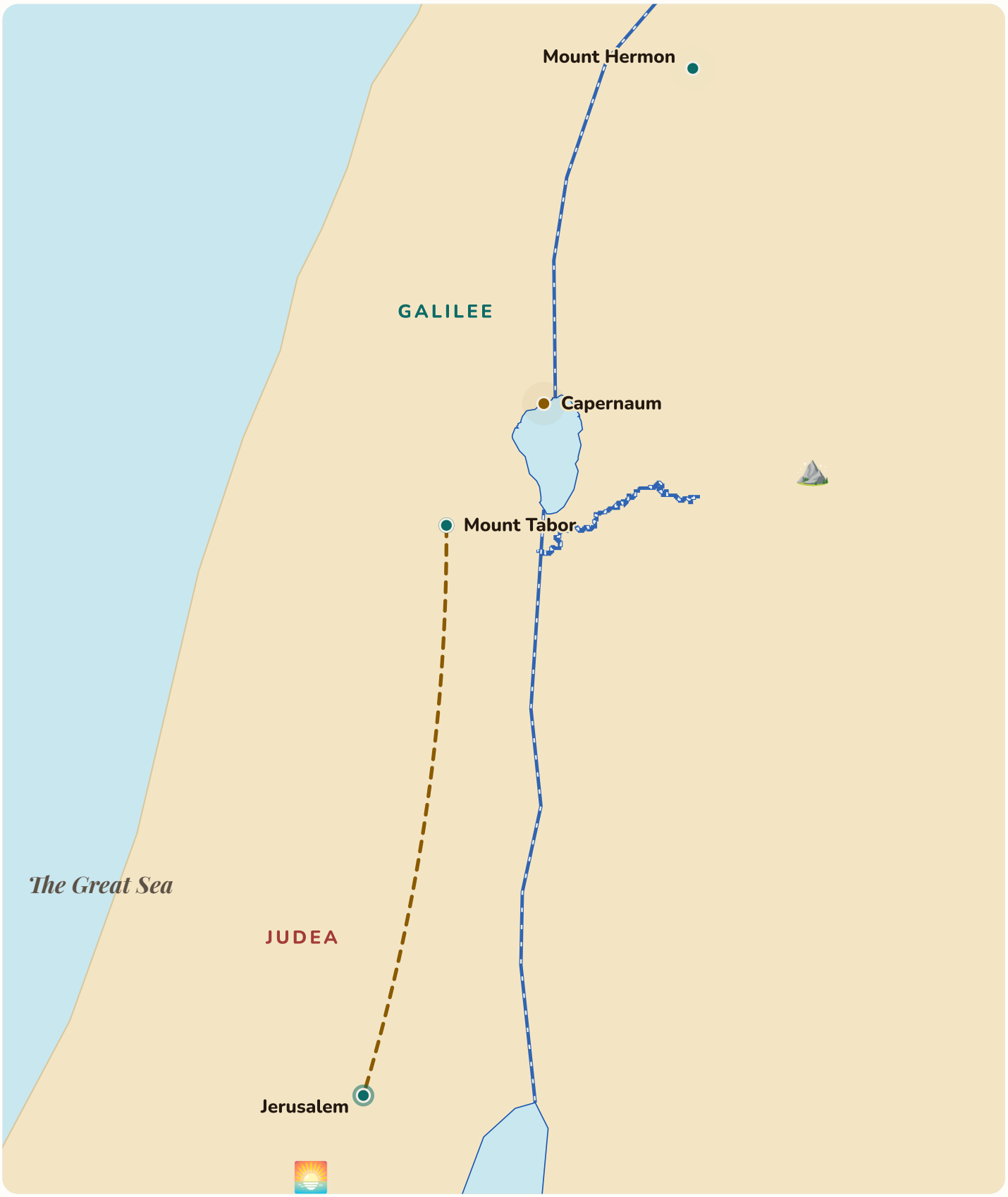
BACKGROUND Judas is gone (27:5).

Matthew 28:16-20 | ◆ Disciples

07 · BACKGROUND

From the tomb to the mountain

The pin outlined in the video's color is a place the video points to. Gold pins are background.



● Named in the video ● Background

Positions from known sites; the route to Galilee is schematic, and the mountain is not named in Matthew. Coastline, Dead Sea and most rivers: Natural Earth (public domain). Sea of Galilee outline and the Yarmuk River: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Jerusalem VIDEO

Mount Tabor VIDEO

The empty tomb, and the guards' report to the chief priests (28:11).

◆ Factbook: Jerusalem

One suggestion for 'the mountain which Jesus had designated' (28:16).

◆ Factbook: Mount Tabor

Mount Hermon VIDEO

Another suggestion, just north of Galilee; we are not told.

◆ Factbook: Mount Hermon

Capernaum BACKGROUND

Jesus' Galilean base, where many earlier lessons were given (4:13).

◆ Factbook: Capernaum

08

Key terms

Great Commission

VIDEO

Jesus' charge in 28:18-20 to make disciples of all the nations.

◆ Factbook: Great Commission

The name of God

VIDEO

In Scripture, God's power, authority and presence, not only a word spoken.

Sabbath day's journey

BACKGROUND

The short distance one might walk on the Sabbath (Acts 1:12).

◆ Factbook: Sabbath ◆ Factbook: Sabbath day's journey

The end of the age

VIDEO

The close of this age at Jesus' return.

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

ἐγείρω

egeirō G1453

To raise, wake; passive, to rise.

Greek · Matt 28:6

προσκυνέω

proskyneō G4352

To bow down, worship.

Greek · Matt 28:9, 17

◆ Factbook: Worship

ἐξουσία

exousia G1849

Authority, right, power.

Greek · Matt 28:18

μαθητεύω

mathēteuō G3100

To make disciples; the main command of 28:19. Look up: BDAG, μαθητεύω.

Greek · Matt 28:19

βαπτίζω

baptizō G907

To dip, immerse, baptize.

Greek · Matt 28:19

◆ Factbook: Baptism

ὄνομα

onoma G3686

Name; also person, authority, reputation.

Greek · Matt 28:19

συντέλεια

synteleia G4930

Completion, end.

Greek · Matt 28:20

שֵׁם

shem H8034

Name; reputation, presence.

Hebrew · Num 6:27

שַׁחַת

shachath H7845

Pit, corruption.

Hebrew · Ps 16:10

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Rolling-stone tombs

Some wealthy tombs near Jerusalem were closed with a large disc-shaped stone set in a groove; most used a block stone. Either way, moving it took several people.

Women as witnesses

Josephus records that the law of his day did not accept women's testimony (Antiquities 4.219), which makes the Gospels' choice of women as first witnesses striking.

Sabbath travel

By the first century the Sabbath limit was fixed at a short walk, 'a Sabbath day's journey' (Acts 1:12), later set at 2,000 cubits in rabbinic law.

SOURCED

Early witnesses

> *And indeed when should they have stolen Him? On the Sabbath? And how? For it was not lawful so much as to go out.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 89, on 28:13. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *And if some doubted, herein again admire their truthfulness, how they conceal not even their shortcomings up to the last day.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 90, on 28:17. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *For tell me not, says He, of the difficulty of the things: for I am with you, who make all things easy.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 90, on 28:20. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

How many commands?

Grammatically 'make disciples' is the only imperative; 'go' is a participle. Many still read 'go' as carrying the force of a command alongside it.

Which mountain?

Some suggest Tabor, some Hermon, others the hills near the Sea of Galilee. Matthew does not say.

The end of the age

The video reads 'the age' as the messianic age that lasts until Jesus returns; others speak of 'this age' giving way to 'the age to come.' Both point to His return.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- Mark 16:1 names three women: Mary Magdalene, Mary the mother of James, and Salome (the captions garble this).
- Exodus 16:29 and Isaiah 58:13 are about Sabbath rest generally; the fixed walking limit (Acts 1:12) comes from later tradition.
- That Matthew tells verses 2-4 before verse 1 in time is the video's inference from comparing the Gospels.

- The longer ending of Mark (16:9-20) is missing from the earliest manuscripts, so the video's Mark 16:12-20 reference rests on it.

11 · BACKGROUND

From the priestly blessing to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 28 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1446 BC DEBATED
The priestly blessing: My name
Numbers 6:27

C. 1000 BC DEBATED
David: not to see corruption
Psalm 16:10 *Echoed: 28:6*

C. 750 BC DEBATED
Hosea: on the third day
Hosea 6:2

C. 550 BC DEBATED
Daniel: dominion given to the Son of Man
Daniel 7:14 *Echoed: 28:18*

C. AD 30 DEBATED
The empty tomb
Matthew 28:1-15 *This episode*

C. AD 30 DEBATED
The Great Commission
Matthew 28:16-20 *This episode*

C. AD 390
Chrysostom: they conceal not their shortcomings
Matthew 28:17

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

1 Corinthians 15:3-8
The witnesses to the risen Christ
ADDED

Acts 1:8
You will be My witnesses
ADDED

John 14:16-18
I will not leave you as orphans

Philippians 2:9-11
The name above every name

ADDED

ADDED

Romans 6:11-13

Consider yourselves alive to God

ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1. Why do you think no Gospel describes the moment of the resurrection itself?
2. What does it tell you that women were the first witnesses?
3. Why might some of the eleven still have doubted on the mountain?
4. If 'make disciples' is the one command, how should going, baptizing and teaching serve it?
5. What does the name of God mean in Numbers 6, Deuteronomy 18 and Psalm 20?
6. When you feel far from God, how could Romans 6:11 reorient your perspective?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson: in Jesus, the disciples possess the power, the authority and the presence of God, and they must go and immerse others into the same. When we feel far from God, our position has not changed; our perspective needs reminding. Paul's answer is to consider ourselves dead to sin and alive to God in Christ Jesus (Romans 6:2-4, 11), a daily practice. Jesus has all authority today, and His power and presence are ours, whatever we feel. Making disciples is more than a few sentences about the gospel: it means spending time with people so they are baptized into so much more. This closes the Matthew study.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

name one person you could walk with this year, meeting regularly to read Scripture and pray together.

> *In Jesus, the disciples possess the power, the authority, and the presence of God. Therefore, they must go and immerse others into this same power, authority, and presence.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ David ◆ Moses ◆ Isaiah ◆ Flavius Josephus ◆ Holy Spirit ◆ Trinity ◆ Galilee
◆ Baptism ◆ Angel ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Capernaum ◆ Book of Deuteronomy ◆ Book of Psalms
◆ Worship ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Disciples ◆ Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Mount Hermon
◆ Prayer ◆ Sea of Galilee ◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Daniel (the prophet) ◆ Hosea (the prophet)
◆ Jacob (son of Isaac) ◆ Joel (the prophet) ◆ Paul ◆ Priest ◆ Sheol ◆ Son of Man
◆ Ancient of Days ◆ Messiah ◆ Rabbi ◆ Sabbath ◆ Aaron ◆ Mount Tabor ◆ Elder
◆ Resurrection ◆ Pontius Pilate ◆ Great Commission ◆ Mary (Magdalene)
◆ Mary (mother of James and Joseph) ◆ Salome (witnessed the crucifixion) ◆ Aaronic blessing
◆ Jesus was the prophet like Moses ◆ Sabbath day's journey

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Images: Wikimedia Commons (James Tissot, Brooklyn Museum; Duccio di Buoninsegna; public domain). Map: drawn for this study.